What is Algebra?

Algebra is an area of mathematics where we don't know the value of part of an equation. For example:

12 + □ = 19

In this case, we don't know what the second number in the equation is, so we put a □ in the place where the number would go.

Here is another way to write the same equation:

12 + X = 19

We still don't know what the second number is, but this time we put a letter where the number would go instead.

You can use any letter or symbol instead of a number:

12 + a = 19 **12 + j = 19** **12 + □ = 19** **12 + 😎 = 19**

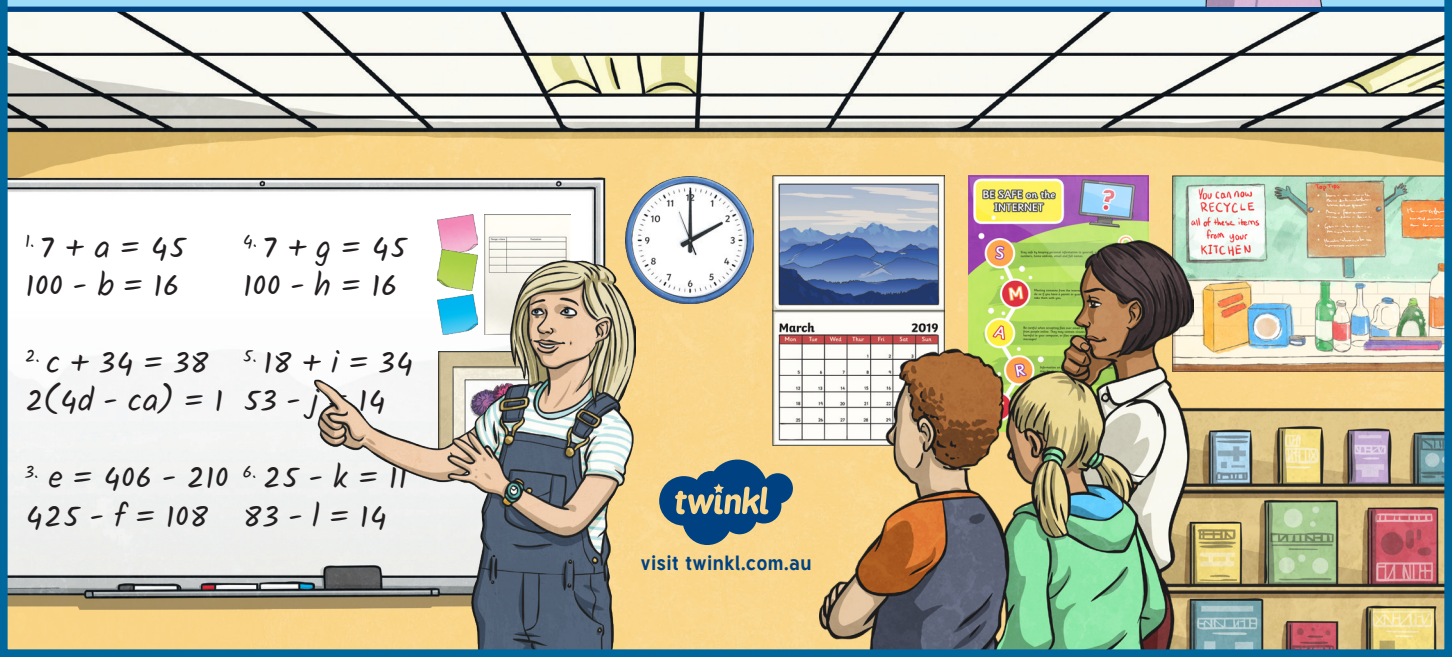
The idea of algebra is to work out what the unknown part of the equation is by using what you know about inverse operations and mathematics.

12 + 😎 = 19

So...

😎 = 19 - 12

😎 = 7



twinkl
visit twinkl.com.au